```
3.1.3 :001 > Order.column_names
=> ["id", "name", "address", "email", "pay_type", "created_at", "updated_at"]
```

Then we'll ask for the details of the `pay_type` column:

```
>> Order.columns_hash["pay_type"]
 =>
#<ActiveRecord::ConnectionAdapters::Column:0x00000001094cc200
 @collation=nil,
 @comment=nil,
 @default=nil,
 @default_function=nil,
 @name="pay_type",
 @null=true,
 @sql_type_metadata=
  #<ActiveRecord::ConnectionAdapters::SqlTypeMetadata:0x00000001094dc178
   @limit=nil,
   @precision=nil,
   @scale=nil,
   @sql_type="integer",
   @type=:integer>>
```

Notice that Active Record has gleaned a fair amount of information about the `pay_type` column. It knows that it's an integer, it has no default value, it isn't the primary key, and it may contain a null value. Rails obtained this information by asking the underlying database the first time we tried to use the `Order` class.

The attributes of an Active Record instance generally correspond to the data in the corresponding row of the database table. For example, our `orders` table might contain the following data:

```
depot> sqlite3 -line db/development.sqlite3 "select * from orders limit 1"
        id = 1
      name = Dave Thomas
   address = 123 Main St
     email = customer@example.com
  pay_type = 0
created_at = 2022-02-14 14:39:12.375458
updated_at = 2022-02-14 14:39:12.375458
```

If we fetched this row into an Active Record object, that object would have seven attributes. The `id` attribute would be `1` (an `Integer`), the `name` attribute would